

205 Make an earwig hide

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MINS

Fast-moving earwigs belong to a group of bug that is “thigmotactic,” meaning they prefer small, cramped spaces like cracks or crevices. This can make them hard to catch, but making this hide should do the trick.

What you need

- Plastic flowerpot
- Short bamboo stake
- Honey
- Straw

1 Block up any holes in the flowerpot and stuff the pot loosely with straw. Drizzle a little honey over the straw.

2 Push a short stake into the ground near a compost heap or flowerbed. Position the upturned flowerpot on top of the stake.

3 Check the hide after about a week. There should now be several earwigs inside, and you'll be able to get a good look at them without losing them down a small space. Just let them go when you're finished.

Males have curved pincers



206 Tempt earwigs with food

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You can tempt earwigs with a variety of foods. They like rotting plant matter, food scraps, and fungi, but they like sweet things as well. Try different foods to see which works best.

